



01

15 steps to cashflow

A practical companion to the full business plan

THE FIRST COMMERCIAL MILESTONE

Deliver a worthwhile paid tour to four guests at the selected price. Then repeat it with five to six guests per departure while paying for all owner time and controlling overhead.

Recommended test: **Branch B only, six paid weeks, two departures per week, four guests minimum and eight maximum.** The proposed ticket is **\$100**; the website still describes \$195 until a pricing decision is implemented. Guests buy their own Muni fares, coffee and admissions.

Work in this order	Steps	Why it matters
Choose the offer and funding	1-2	Set one price test and a cash limit.
Make delivery viable	3-6	Confirm permissions, coverage, route and timing.
Make the offer purchasable	7-10	Clear terms, dates, public access and verified checkout.
Generate and deliver bookings	11-13	Find paying visitors and complete the promised experience.
Protect cash and prove repeatability	14-15	Reconcile liabilities, owner pay and expansion decisions.

Accountability: the owner/operator coordinates these actions; professional and technical help is used where needed. **Timing:** allow roughly one to two weeks of preparation, but approvals or route issues can extend it. No start date is set. Steps 3-7 can progress alongside one another when dependencies permit.

Cost rule: amounts shown in the steps draw from the same budget, not 15 additional budgets. Total provisional starting cash is \$3,000; the detailed allocation is on page 7. Log all setup work against the 16-hour estimate and revise it when exceeded. Avoid new sign hardware, a vehicle, rent or extra staff before demand is demonstrated.

Reading guide: steps 1-15 are on pages 2-6; cash targets and assumptions are on page 7; the weekly review sheet and sources are on page 8. All steps are pending operating evidence, not recorded as completed.



02

Choose the offer and confirm requirements

Steps 1-3 / owner: operator / mark complete only with evidence

01 / Select one sellable pilot offer

Choose Branch B, 2-5:30 PM, eight guests maximum, ages 16+, with guest-paid Muni and coffee. Decide whether to adopt the proposed \$100 pilot price and four-person minimum.

When / dependency: First decision; before any selling material is released.

Cost: \$0 external spend; record owner decision time.

Done when: One offer sheet states price, duration, endpoint, inclusions and exclusions. The current \$195 price is replaced only after the decision is made.

Assumptions/goals register: A01-A08; G01

02 / Set the cash limit and start the ledger

Record available business cash, existing paid items, personal runway and required owner draws. Use a separate business money record for bookings, refunds, expenses and all owner hours.

When / dependency: Immediately after step 1; update weekly.

Cost: \$3,000 provisional funding: \$2,250 spend + \$750 cushion.

Done when: The funding source and spending ceiling are recorded. The extra \$640 of modeled owner setup time remains visible even if payment is deferred.

Assumptions/goals register: A25-A32; G11, G17

03 / Confirm registration, licenses and location use

Ask the relevant SF offices for the current guide permit/license process, registration and name requirements. Confirm the exact Wharf meeting-point jurisdiction and permitted use before paying for signs.

When / dependency: Begin early; approval timing can determine the launch date.

Cost: \$900 allowance for permit, registration and name paperwork.

Done when: Required applications, current fee quotes and evidence of permissions are recorded. Necessary approvals are in place before paid operation; registration alone is insufficient.

Assumptions/goals register: A25, A41, A46; G01



03

Cover the risk and rehearse the route

Steps 4-6 / owner: operator / mark complete only with evidence

04 / Secure suitable insurance

Get a written quote for the actual walking-and-Muni tour, meeting area and group size. Confirm coverage dates and any conditions imposed by sites or partners.

When / dependency: Alongside step 3; active before paid operation.

Cost: \$600 initial pilot-insurance allowance; replace with quote.

Done when: Coverage and premium are documented. If an annual minimum costs more, revise the funding target before committing. Count this premium once in pilot overhead.

Assumptions/goals register: A26, A41; G01

05 / Lock the route and coffee alternative

Field-check the Wharf-to-Dogpatch connection, RH coffee option, Chase Center/Mission Bay and Oracle Park finish. Confirm restrooms, walking demands, accessible alternatives and a quick replacement coffee break.

When / dependency: During preparation, before rehearsals and public route promises.

Cost: Use the \$150 shared essentials/rehearsal allowance as needed.

Done when: Exact meeting/finish points and stop notes are written. RH service is workable or replaced; no free coffee, guaranteed seating or office access is promised.

Assumptions/goals register: A09-A16; G02

06 / Complete two full route rehearsals

Walk and ride the complete B route at its intended time with volunteers. Practice the Muni lesson, delayed vehicle, café queue and separated-guest procedures. Cut optional detours that do not fit.

When / dependency: After step 5 and before a paid departure.

Cost: Part of the 16-hour total setup budget; log overruns.

Done when: Two dated logs show a safe 3.5-hour guest experience and realistic preparation/closeout time. The guide can teach an onward Muni trip; free guests do not count as paid demand.

Assumptions/goals register: A10-A24; G02, G09-G11



04

Create a clear offer people can buy

Steps 7-9 / owner: operator / mark complete only with evidence

07 / Finalize refund terms and tax treatment

Write customer cancellation terms, operator refunds, minimum-departure notice and clear exclusions. Confirm applicable tax treatment and advertised-price rules for this exact service before charging.

When / dependency: After the offer is selected; before payments are accepted.

Cost: \$300 focused terms/tax/accounting review allowance.

Done when: Customer terms and reviewed checkout charges match the offer. Recommended operator cancellation: full refund or optional reschedule. Do not add an invented general SF tour tax.

Assumptions/goals register: A27, A42-A45; G01, G17

08 / Choose 12 dates and a capacity ledger

Schedule two Branch B departures per week for six weeks, proposed Saturday/Sunday afternoons. Record eight available seats per date, payment holds and the proposed four-person minimum.

When / dependency: After readiness timing is credible; before offering specific dates.

Cost: \$0 new calendar subscription assumed.

Done when: All 12 dates, seat counts, hold rules and the selected confirmation deadline are recorded. Proposed minimum-departure notice is 48 hours ahead and must be disclosed before payment.

Assumptions/goals register: A17-A19, A44; G05, G07

09 / Publish a working phone purchase path

Make one public page show the selected offer, dates, meeting directions, contact and terms. Use the existing booking system or manually confirm seats before sending a matching Stripe Payment Link.

When / dependency: After steps 1, 7 and 8; public access must be selected and tested.

Cost: \$120 six-week web/phone/admin cash allowance; standard processing.

Done when: A tourist can view the offer without the owner login and purchase the correct date/quantity. The current owner-private preview and disabled checkout are not a sales channel.

Assumptions/goals register: A35-A37, A47-A48; G01



05

Test checkout and find paying visitors

Steps 10-12 / owner: operator / mark complete only with evidence

10 / Test payment, confirmation and refund

On a phone, test a complete booking, confirmation, calendar details, seat reconciliation and refund using appropriate test credentials. Test wrong inputs and prevent duplicate or excess seats.

When / dependency: After step 9; pass this check before live selling.

Cost: Record setup time and any actual test/refund fees; no new subscription assumed.

Done when: Payment is verified in Stripe or the verified backend, not only by a browser redirect. Correct receipt, meeting information and refunded/released capacity are evidenced.

Assumptions/goals register: A47-A48; G01, G17

11 / Sell the first four seats

Ask existing contacts for introductions to visiting groups. Offer one party of four or two parties of two the selected pilot date, at the stated price with the same clear terms.

When / dependency: Once steps 3-10 establish readiness to accept payment.

Cost: \$0 paid ads for this first attempt; count selling time.

Done when: Four seats are paid and correctly recorded; \$400 if the \$100 pilot price is adopted. Distinguish independent visitors from supportive friends. Do not count inquiries as bookings.

Assumptions/goals register: A02, A07-A08; G03, G06

12 / Build two repeatable sources of bookings

Approach five to ten suitable hotels, hostels or visitor partners. Request permitted indoor QR placement or referrals, use source codes, and test a small paid message only after the purchase path works.

When / dependency: After the first sale; continue through the pilot.

Cost: \$180 total six-week marketing test, roughly \$30/week.

Done when: Each booking has a source; spend and owner sales time are tracked. Target cash acquisition at or below \$10 per paid guest while respecting the total budget. Add actual commissions.

Assumptions/goals register: A29, A40, A46; G06, G12



06

Deliver, reconcile and repeat

Steps 13-15 / owner: operator / mark complete only with evidence

13 / Confirm and deliver the first departures

Apply the published minimum-departure rule and refund/reschedule promptly if it fails. Check transit and events, deliver the tour, teach an onward journey and collect short value/Muni feedback.

When / dependency: Confirmation deadline before each date; first paid operating week.

Cost: At four \$100 guests: \$193.70 delivery + \$12.80 modeled card fees + \$12 reserve.

Done when: Paid guests actually complete the experience. Record actual attendance, hours, finish time, spend and route changes; keep empty/canceled dates in the demand record.

Assumptions/goals register: A16-A24; G05, G07-G11, G16

14 / Reconcile cash and pay from delivered work

Match bookings to Stripe deposits, refunds and delivered revenue. Record all owner hours and actual costs; retain enough for undelivered-booking refunds and obligations due before the next reliable payout.

When / dependency: After each departure; weekly and before owner draws.

Cost: \$750 working cushion is retained cash, not an expense.

Done when: The ledger distinguishes bank cash, earned revenue and refund liabilities. Owner pay comes from available delivered-tour cash; expected sales or a positive spreadsheet are not cash in the bank.

Assumptions/goals register: A24, A30-A37, A48; G11, G13, G17

15 / Review at weeks three and six; scale selectively

At week 3, diagnose demand, value and actual costs. At week 6, compare the full scorecard and make a written go/revise/stop decision. Test one extra date or price change before adding routes/staff.

When / dependency: End of weeks 3 and 6, measured from actual pilot start.

Cost: Any follow-up test needs a separate spending cap and deadline.

Done when: Target 48 paid guests minimum, preferably 60-72; positive operating surplus after all owner time, with 20%+ margin as a stronger signal. Recalculate startup recovery from actual costs.

Assumptions/goals register: A73-A80; G04-G18



07

Know what cashflow success means

Operating contribution, business profit and cash recovery are different

Starting cash allocation	Amount
Initial setup: permits/name \$900 + review \$300 + essentials \$150	\$1,350
Pilot overhead: insurance \$600 + marketing \$180 + web/phone/admin \$120	\$900
Working-cash cushion retained in the business	\$750
Provisional starting-cash target	\$3,000

Quotes may change this target. Initial owner setup time adds **16 hours x \$40 = \$640** of economic cost; it is outside the cash target when payment is deferred. Personal living-expense runway and prior sunk development costs are excluded.

12 completed departures	Revenue	Operating surplus	After setup*
4 guests each / 48 total	\$4,800	\$558.00	-\$1,432.00
5 guests each / 60 total	\$6,000	\$1,659.60	-\$330.40
6 guests each / 72 total	\$7,200	\$2,761.20	\$771.20

Model: \$100 ticket; 72 operating owner hours at \$40 (4.5 hours per departure plus 3 admin hours/week); \$900 pilot overhead; \$68.40 guide fares; \$2 materials per guest; domestic processing 2.9% + \$0.30 per guest; 3% service-recovery reserve. Returns and tips excluded. *After setup deducts \$1,350 cash and \$640 initial owner time. All results are before income tax.

THREE CHECKPOINTS

One four-person tour: \$181.50 contribution after delivery labor, guide fare, materials, modeled processing and reserve, before shared overhead/admin.

Six weeks: aim for 60-72 paying guests and positive actual operating surplus.

Full modeled recovery: about 64 paid guests cover operating costs and setup including owner time; replace estimates with actuals.

Stripe typically schedules the first payout within 7-14 days and may take longer. Keep undelivered-booking refunds funded; the 3% reserve and \$750 cushion are not substitutes for that obligation. Owner labor remains costed at \$40; SF's current \$19.61 minimum wage does not replace a full employee-cost budget. See sources on page 8.



08

Run this review every operating week

Complete with actuals; blank values mean not measured, not zero

Record	Actual / next action
Week / review date / first paid operating date	_____
Offered / completed / canceled departures	_____
Paid guests / revenue from delivered tours	_____
Bank cash / expected payout / unearned refund liability	_____
Owner setup / guiding / return / admin hours	_____
Actual spend / acquisition cost and guests by source	_____
Operating surplus / margin / setup still unrecovered	_____
Survey counts / value / Muni confidence / on-time rate	_____
Decision / next action / owner / review deadline	_____

Week 3: about 24 paid guests is the midpoint pace check. **Week 6:** seek 48 minimum, 60-72 preferred; at least 10 of 12 dates delivered; 80% good/excellent value and Muni confidence; 90% on-time completion; positive economics after owner hours. Report survey denominators and seek at least 30 responses. These are internal targets, not industry standards.

If demand is weak, fix the message or sales source before adding dates. If guests do not see value, revise the experience. If actual costs exceed receipts after owner time, revise the budget and offer before expansion. Document a capped follow-up test rather than indefinitely extending the pilot.

Sources: [31] SF Police Code: guide permits and licensing | [32] SF Treasurer: business registration | [34] California DOJ: advertised prices and hidden fees | [35] CDTFA: destination-management services | [27] SF: minimum wage effective July 1, 2026 | [01] SFMTA: fares and day pass | [28] Stripe: standard processing fees | [29] Stripe: Payment Links | [30] Stripe: payout timing

Companion records: Full Business Plan and Assumptions and Goals tracker, dated September 14, 2026. Step references A01-A80 and G01-G18 match that register. Published inputs were checked in the September 8-14 research; recheck fees, permissions and payment terms before use. This plan records actions to take, not evidence they have been completed.